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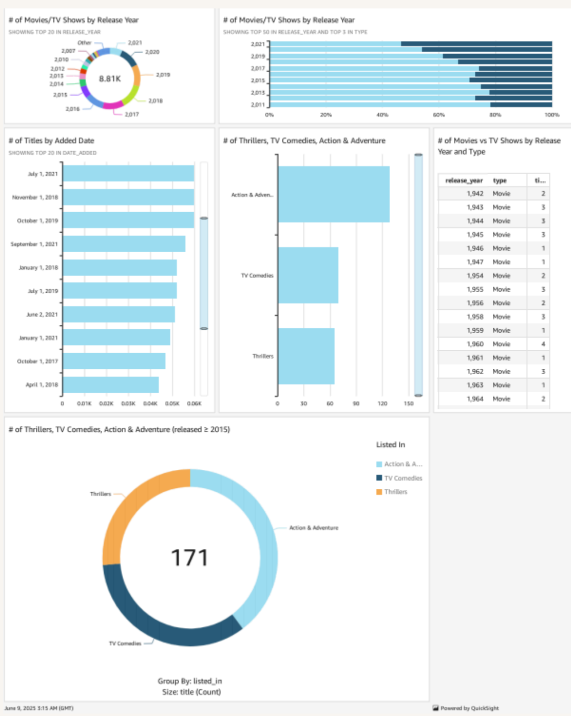
Visualize data with QuickSight

A

Amir Hamzah



Introducing Today's Project!

In this project, I will demonstrate how to use Amazon QuickSight to analyze Netflix data and generate visualizaions and insights! I'm doing this project to learn how to use cloud data services for data analysis

Tools and concepts

Services I used were QuickSight and S3. Key concepts I learnt include manifest.json files,data visualization technique (e.g. chart,filters_ and how to perform a data refresh in QuickSight.

Project reflection

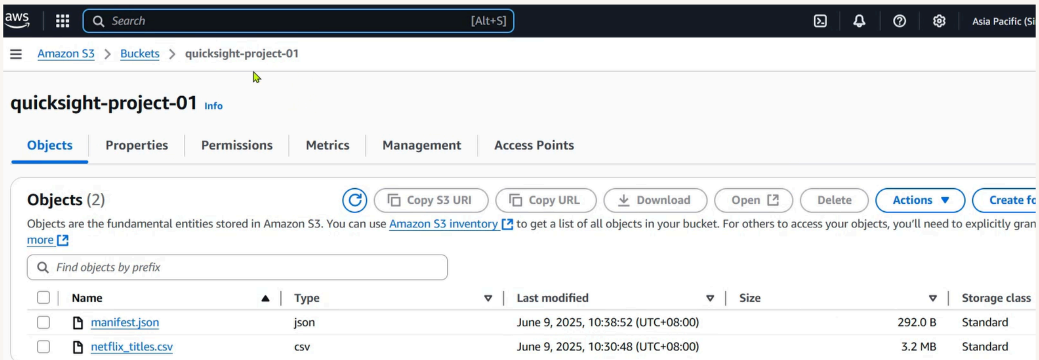
This project took me approximately 2 hours including demo time. The most challenging part was understanding how a manifest.json file works. It was most rewarding to generating PDF of my finished visualization.

After this project, I plan to work on day THREE of the AWS Beginner Challenge. I will start this project on soon!

Upload project files into S3

S3 is used in this project to store two files, which are manifest.json(which tells QuickSight about the structure and the format of the data I analyzing) and netfilix_titles.csv (which is the raw data that I'm here to analyze today).

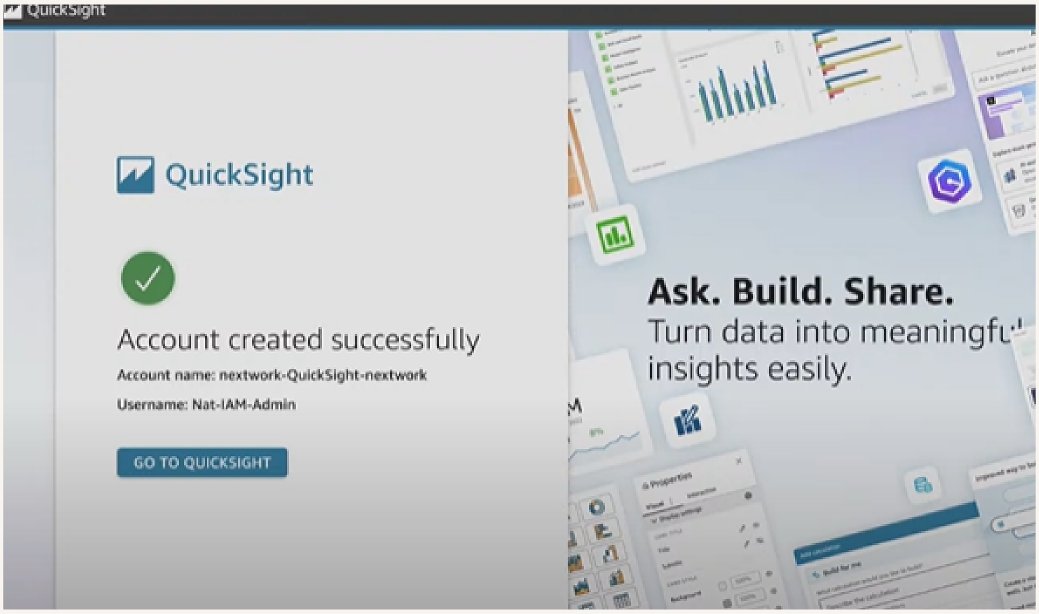
I edited the manifest.json file by updating S3 URI that corresponds to my dataset's file location.It’s important to edit this file because it's how quickSight will find and analyze the data.



Create QuickSight account

Creating a QuickSight account cost $0 as comes with a 30 day free trial.Make sure to UNCHECK an add-on in the sign up flow called Pixel-Perfect Reports so I don't ger charged.

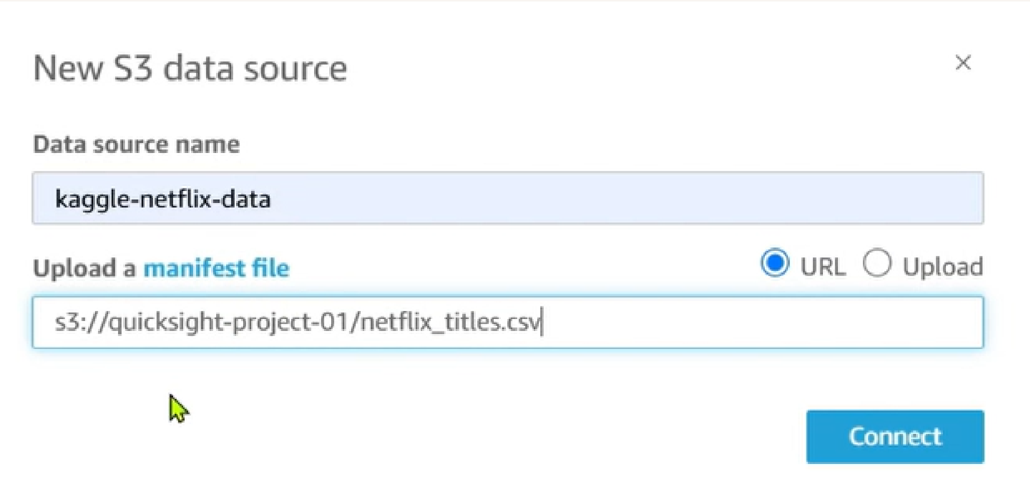
Creating an account took me about 5 minutes including setting up my S3 bucket's permission



Download the Dataset

I connected the S3 bucket to QuickSight by visiting the Datasets page.There were so many options for data sources I could connect to(database and external tools/platform likes Saleforce) ,and we selected S3.

The manifest.json file was important in this step because it tells QuickSight how to read the data – in this project,it tells QuickSight that we're uploading a .CSV file and the delimiter so that QuickSight knows how to break up the data for analysis

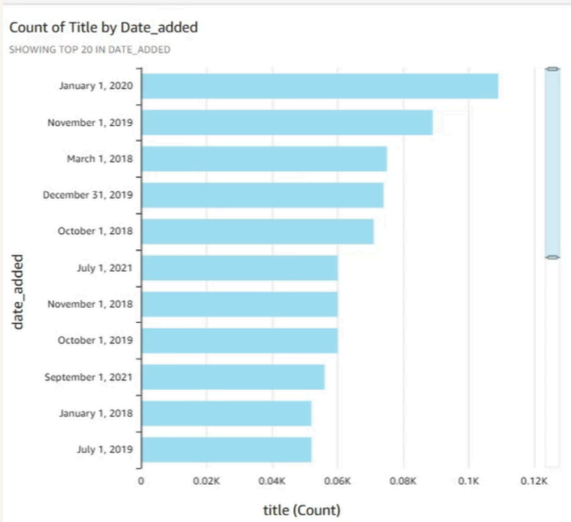


My first visualization

To create visualizations on QuickSight, I simply have to click on data fild,labels e.g. release year and QuickSight will automatically generate a graphic that best suits that type of data.

The chart shown here is a breakdown of date added of the content inside the Netflix – i.e. how many titles and date added on xyz year.

I created this graph by dragging and dropping date_added on Y axis and title (Count) for x Axis.



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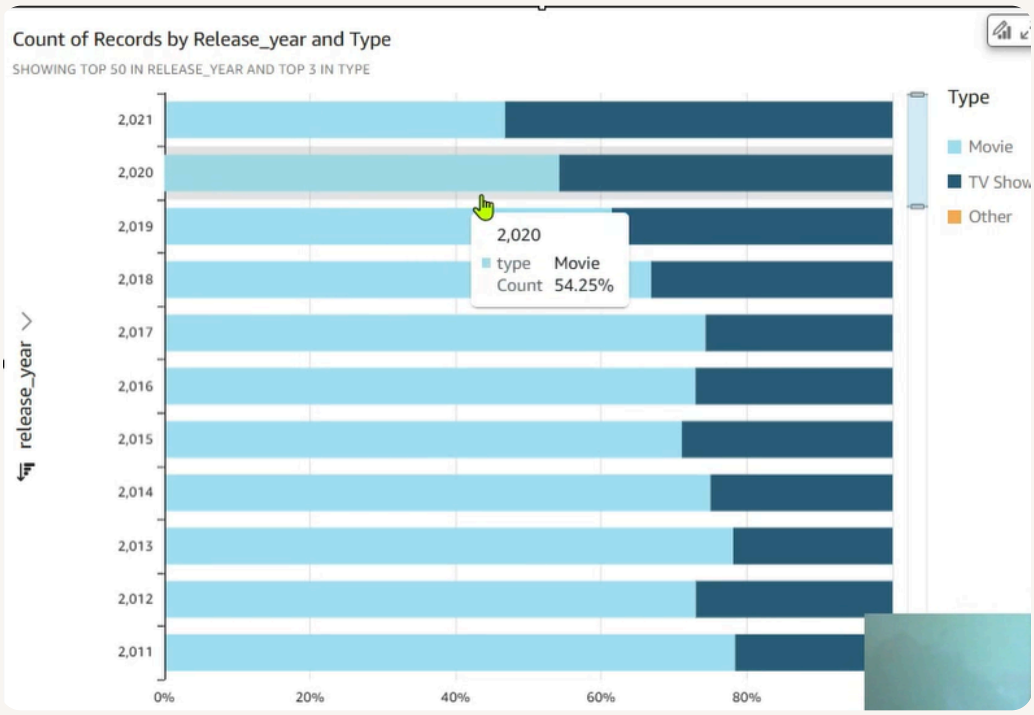
Using filters

Filters are useful for narrowing down my data to the subset that I want to focues on, and in this case, I could use filter to focus on the specific categories that we want to analyze.

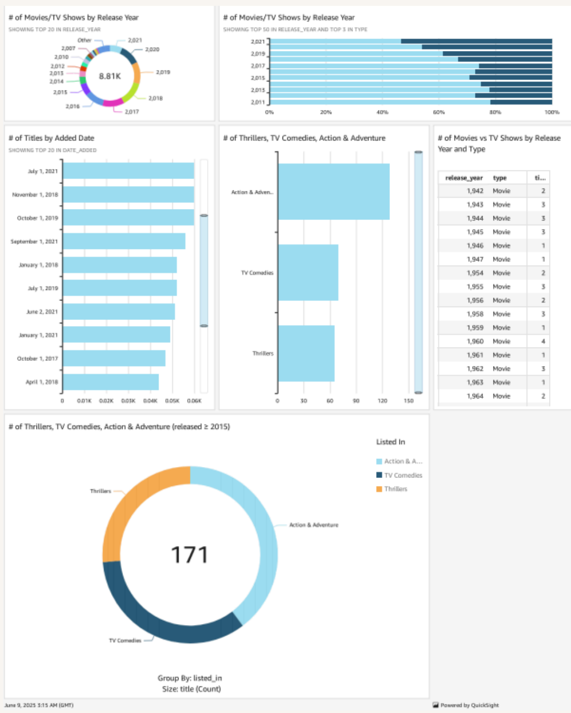
This visualization is a breakdown of TV Shows/Movies that belong in one of three categories – action and adventure,tv comedies and thrilles. Here I added a filter based on the 'listed on' data label.



Setting up a dashboard

As a finishing touch, I updated the titles of the charts in our dashboards so that they are easily readable. The default name would simply mention the data labels e.g. released_year, but new titles communicate the purpose of a chart clearly.

Did you know you could export your dashboard as PDFs too? I did this by selecting Publish and then "Generate PDF" on the top right hand corner of QuickSight analysis.



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